



Rhyme Circle: Listen, Match, Invent

Pre-K • Massachusetts • Phonological awareness

Pre-K RF 2(a)

With adult support, recognize and generate spoken rhymes. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

Pre-K • Massachusetts • Phonological awareness; Pre-K RF 2(a). Focus: With adult support, recognize and generate spoken rhymes.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 1 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Four 8–12-minute supported sessions and a 5-minute oral check. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Listen to the adult, then speak, point, draw, or act your response. Ask to hear the words or story again.

Learn the move

A rhyme has the same ending sound, even when its spelling differs. Say each pair naturally, then stretch the ending. Children may answer by speaking, pointing to a yes/no card, or giving a thumbs signal. Adults read every word; printed-word reading is not expected. Accept a playful invented word if its ending genuinely rhymes, then model a real word. Use four prompts per sitting.

Model 1 • Do moon and spoon rhyme?

Yes. Both end with the spoken /oon/ sound. The first sounds differ.

Model 2 • Give a rhyme for cake.

Lake, make, or bake works. Repeat the pair slowly so the ending can be heard.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



Adult routine

Say: Listen first. Tell me if the endings sound the same. Then you will choose or invent a rhyme. Demonstrate YES and NOT YET response signals. Do not require spelling. For a three-word choice, repeat all three without emphasizing the answer.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Listen to the adult, then speak, point, draw, or act your response. Ask to hear the words or story again.

1. Do boat and coat rhyme?

2. Do sun and sock rhyme?

3. Which rhymes with fish: dish or fan?

4. Which rhymes with tree: bee or truck?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Listen to the adult, then speak, point, draw, or act your response. Ask to hear the words or story again.

5. Do light and kite rhyme?

6. Do cup and cap rhyme?

7. Which rhymes with snail: trail or snow?

8. Which rhymes with chair: hair or shoe?



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Listen to the adult, then speak, point, draw, or act your response. Ask to hear the words or story again.

9. Say a rhyme for day.

10. Say a rhyme for ring.

11. Say a rhyme for red.

12. Say a rhyme for log.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Listen to the adult, then speak, point, draw, or act your response. Ask to hear the words or story again.

13. Find the odd ending: bear, pear, boat.

14. Find the odd ending: nest, best, nose.

15. Finish a silly line with a rhyme: A mouse sat by a ____.

16. Make your own two-word rhyme pair.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Adult reads prompts; record independent responses with the usual access supports.

17. Do rain and train rhyme?

18. Which rhymes with bug: rug or bag?

19. Say a rhyme for hop.

20. Which does not rhyme: seed, need, sand?



Answers and response criteria

1. Yes; their ending sounds match.
2. No; matching first sounds do not make a rhyme.
3. Dish; fish/dish have matching endings.
4. Bee; tree/bee end alike.
5. Yes; sound, not matching spelling, decides.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. No; their vowel sounds differ.

7. Trail.

8. Hair.

9. Examples: play, stay, hay. Accept any matching ending.

10. Examples: sing, king, wing.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. Examples: bed, head, said; spelling is irrelevant.
12. Examples: dog or fog; accept the child's consistent dialect.
13. Boat. Bear and pear rhyme.
14. Nose. Nest and best rhyme.
15. House is one answer. Accept another genuine rhyme; meaning may be silly.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. Accept two distinct words with the same ending sound, such as blue/shoe.

17. Yes.

18. Rug.

19. Examples: top, mop, stop.

20. Sand.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask the learner to invent a new rhyme pair or retell from another character's view; explain the choice.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Read all directions and stories aloud; model one response; use gestures, pictures drawn by the learner, or AAC. Record exact responses without demanding writing.

ESL

Explain word meanings with gestures before rhyme listening. Invite home-language retelling first; compare the target English sounds without judging accent.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the cited standard; this is not a full curriculum or official practice test. The source prints Pre-K Reading Foundations, standard 2, subsection a (PDF page 30); this reference preserves that structure rather than inventing a compact code.

Official state standard • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://www.doe.mass.edu/frameworks/ela/2017-06.pdf>

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